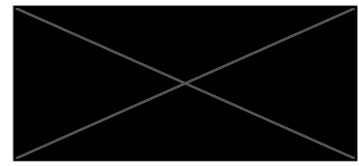


DEC. 29, 1980



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For Fund Use Only

A PRELIMINARY REPORT ON THE CASH/LANDRUM NEW CANEY CEII CASE
by Allan Hendry for the Fund for UFO Research

- * Betty Cash
- * The Automobile
- * Vicky Landrum
- * Additional Witnesses
- * Medical Follow-up
- * The Microwave Hypothesis
- * Attempt to Confirm Helicopters

NEW CANEY, TX



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NOTES ON AN INTERVIEW WITH BETTY CASH

On the evening of April 2, I spoke with Betty Cash at her parents' home at 209 48 Street, Fairfield, Alabama (2[REDACTED]). The phone call lasted about 40 minutes. In that time, she recounted essentially the same story she had told John Schuessler, with one odd discrepancy. I found her to be a pleasant and cooperative witness.

Betty Cash, 52, was running a truck stop restaurant/grocery store (night shift) until this incident took place. Now, she is convalescing at her mother's. Her UFO background before December, 1980: "I never did believe in UFO's. In fact, I hadn't even heard of one in years. The first one I heard about, I laughed and I thought, 'Oh, well, they're having hallucinations,' you know. I'll be the last one to laugh any more." Indeed, she was "afraid" to go to the hospital afterwards, for fear that she would be dismissed as "crazy".

The incident happened around 9-9:15 PM on December 29, 1980. Betty was driving her 1980 Oldsmobile Cutlass Supreme in the company of neighbor Vicky Landrum, 57, and her grandson Colby, 7. They were en route to Huffman from New Caney, Texas on the "Farm Market" road (148F) that connects the two, closer to New Caney. This is a rural road lined with pine trees and some oak trees which John Schuessler notes is in bad condition. Though Huffman is south of New Caney, both women thought they were headed "east" at this point (check the detailed maps to be submitted by Schuessler). The whole sky seemed bright ahead of them, somewhat to their right. Then the witnesses became aware that a vertically oblong form was suspended over the road. The discrepancy in the story as presented to me (vs. to John Schuessler) occurs here, pertaining to the reason the car came to a stop. Cash has been telling others that she stopped the car rather than attempt to drive under the flames being emitted down toward the ground from the blindingly luminous form. Inquiring about the "roughness" noted in her car's performance after the event, as noted to Schuessler, I was surprised at her new portrayal as follows:

Hendry: "... Did the car start acting rough from that moment on?"

Cash: "Yes, it sure did."

Hendry: "From that moment on?"

Cash: "It sure did. It killed the motor in the car!"

Hendry: "It killed the motor?"

Cash: "Yes!"

Hendry: "So, when you stopped the car, you had the motor running?"

Cash: "Yes."



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Hendry: "But you, yourself, didn't shut it off?"

Cash: "No."

Hendry: "The motor just stalled out there at the time."

Cash: "It just quit on its own, and that's what... one of those things that shook me up. I was beginning to wonder, 'what if we can't get out of here? Then what do we do?'"

Hendry: "But at what point did you try starting up the car? After it (the UFO) had started rising up?"

Cash: "After that thing had started getting out of the way."

Interviewed separately, Vicky Landrum recalled Betty restarting the car, but was unaware why the engine shut down. John Schuessler acknowledges being disturbed about this discrepancy; I am sending him a brief copy of my tape recording of the conversation. Still, it was the only possible glitch in this recent retelling of the event.

In the company of Vicky and Colby Landrum, Alan Holt paced off the distance the witnesses felt the UFO was from their car when they all went back to the scene of the sighting in daylight conditions. It turned out to be about 130 feet (not the "yards" stated in the Weekly World News). It hovered about 60-80 feet above that point at treetop level. Its actual size seemed as big as a water tower. Both Cash and Landrum told me that its angular size would not begin to be matched by one's hand outstretched at arm's length.

The uniformly blinding light made it difficult to resolve the exact shape of the oblong form. It may have had four points like a diamond. Flames intermittently "whooshed" downwards toward the road; later examination showed no marks on the pavement. Additionally, a "roar" like a "freight train" permeated the area, and a beeping sound could be heard. The sheer brightness made it difficult for them to regain their night vision afterwards.

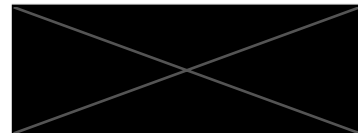
Betty Cash got out of the car and walked a few paces toward the mysterious sight. Vicky Landrum stood up on the right side of the car behind the door, exposing the fingers of one hand to the UFO's light. Cash was exposed to the light the longest: about 5-7 minutes. Landrum got back into the car after 2-3 minutes because Colby was screaming for her to return. The religious Mrs. Landrum thought the sky was going to split and the world was coming to an end. Telling Colby that Jesus would emerge from the light had the effect of calming him down. Colby never left the car.

Everyone felt considerable heat from the UFO, yet Betty was still surprised when the metal door handle was too hot to touch. She was wearing a leather jacket as it was cool outside; she took it off to use as a "pot holder" and grabbed the handle. They had been using the car heater on low, but switched to the air conditioner later to cool down the car's interior.



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Once the UFO started retreating toward the west (in the direction of the Houston Intercontinental Airport, according to the witnesses), Betty and Vicky became aware of many helicopters in the area. They flew toward the UFO, surrounded it and "escorted" it away! The brilliance of the UFO assisted the witnesses' view of the choppers, allowing them to see that there were different types - including single and double (tandem) rotor craft. Betty Cash counted "23". Vicky Landrum stated that there were at least 10-12. Colby asserted that he saw the helicopters throughout the entire incident. Betty would later draw one of the large helicopters and send it to her brother, who was in the Air Force for 30 years. He said it was an Air Force carrier. The sketch was done before pictures of helicopters were sent to Betty by John Schuessler.

As they drove down the road and turned toward Huffman, they got to see the UFO plus helicopters fly off into the distance from 3 different vantage points. This aspect of the event took some 5-10 minutes. Total duration of the incident then: 10-17 minutes. The witnesses do not profess to have lost any memory of time in their trip.

After dropping off the Landrums, Betty Cash arrived home about 9:50 PM, where she met Wilma Emert, her niece and her grandson. Physiological symptoms started appearing within hours; her skin was beet red "as if they had been on the beach all day in August"; her eyes were burning and tearing. She had felt great during the day and ate a lot at the restaurant that night - sausage, eggs, etc. Yet by morning she couldn't eat a bite without feeling sick and vomiting. She was too weak with pain to stray from bed and call for help. Her hair was coming out in patches, her head wracked with a powerful headache. Half-dollar size blisters with clear fluid covered her face and scalp. Betty's neck, ears and eyes were severely swollen; her pierced earrings had to be removed and her eyes were swollen closed. She was blinded by this until she was hospitalized. Like the other witnesses, she experienced some diarrhea. Even her lips had swollen to three times their normal size.

Vicky Landrum talked her into going to the hospital after four days of suffering at home. She was at the Parkway General Hospital in Houston for fifteen days. Since she had undergone a heart bypass operation two years earlier, the examining physician was her cardiologist, Dr. B. B. Shenoy (150 W. Parker Rd., Houston - [REDACTED]). Shenoy has described Betty Cash as "no complainer". She only came to the hospital when it was necessary. This time, however, the nurses asked if she was being admitted as a "burn patient".

The nurses put salve on her eyes which opened up a week later. Burn cream was placed on her face to prevent scarring. Large patches of tissue peeled away from her face. Uninformed about the UFO, Dr. Shenoy called in specialists who couldn't explain the swellings, burns or hair loss. All tests performed (white blood cell counts, eye examination, skin tests, a



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a biopsy, etc.) showed nothing. Her heart was fine.

Betty was sent home with prescriptions for drugs aimed at providing comfort. After several days elapsed, though, she realized she wasn't improving. The vomiting had stopped, but her appetite was not back. She still had the crushing headaches and was constantly tired. So she returned to the hospital. Dermatologist Dr. Louis Burman (spelling?) (508 Herman Professional Building, Houston; [REDACTED]) put cortisone on her skin with a needle. By now, with a second hospital visit lasting 7 days, her medical bill had amounted to \$10,000. Landrum visited Shenoy on a casual basis (not as a patient) and told him of the UFO experience. Shenoy seemed relieved to hear the news, and entered the allegation into her medical record. Oddly, he told Betty a story about the government working on "something" in North or South Carolina that is being transported across the U.S. He also strongly recommended that she go see the movie "Hangar 18"!

As of April 2, Betty still had 75% hair loss and wore a wig to go out of her mother's house. She is visiting the university hospital in Birmingham, Alabama, but claims they are only treating her for comfort. She still produces new water blisters, and has bad headaches. The swelling is down and her family tells her she is looking better each day. The only conclusion the Houston doctors reached about her eyes was to prescribe reading glasses. She is now dissatisfied with their performance.

Interestingly, Betty does not think she had a "UFO" experience, and blames the government instead. She has not worked since the event.

THE AUTOMOBILE

Betty Cash's 1980 Oldsmobile Cutlass Supreme was a Christmas gift, and still under warranty. She noticed no related malfunction prior to the incident. After the sighting, the engine seemed to run roughly and miss. The clock and radio now fail, yet she noticed the clock start up again while driving once to the hospital. Occasionally, the car smelled as if there were burning going on.

Thus, before heading for Alabama, she had a service station check out routine things like her oil and radiator. A new air filter was installed, but no immediate mechanical attention to the complaints was effected. In Birmingham on April 1, she called the local Olds service facility and made an appointment for the following Monday.

Schuessler noted that a plastic lens cover appeared to have been affected by heat and this was removed for further testing.



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VICKY LANDRUM

I also spoke by phone with Vicky Landrum, 57, waitress. Her grandson, Colby, 7, lives with her. She placed the time that they left the restaurant in New Caney as 8-8:15 PM. Her description of the UFO was "oblong" with a pointed bottom. Colby made it "diamond-shaped". Both agreed that the angular size was greater than a hand outstretched at arm's length.

Mrs. Landrum's religious convictions led her to assume that this was a religious event. She now appears to share Betty Cash's conclusion that it was a government/military exercise, noting the "roar" of the helicopters pursuing the UFO. She stopped counting at "14-15".

Vicky's symptoms were similar to Betty's: red skin, burning eyes, diarrhea for three days, bad stomach aches. She suffered 50% hair loss on the side of her head favoring the UFO. Remember, she only stayed out of the car half as long as Betty Cash. The fingernails on the one hand that was exposed to the UFO show a side-to-side linear damage. Vicky notes that new tissue is now growing in, replacing the old. Her eye problems seem more serious than Betty's, though. She used to wear glasses for reading only; now she has a full-time pair, prescribed by Dr. Chandler of Liberty, Texas. Furthermore, her vision is filmy. "I don't know whether my eyes are playing tricks on me or not, but at times it's just like people... I'll be looking right at them and they'll turn into a film, like. Then I'll rub my eyes and it'll go away." Dr. Chandler speculated to her about radiation-induced cataracts in six to twelve months.

These vision problems started the very next day for her. As of my conversation with her in April, her eyes have stopped tearing. Her sunburned-looking complexion has completely healed (she used three bottles of baby oil on both her and her son's face).

Colby seems to have undergone the least severe effects, as if staying in the car afforded him some protection. His face was also sunburned in appearance after the event; as of April, there was only a rough complexion in his cheeks. His diarrhea was so bad that he had to be cleaned for three days like a baby. He also had stomach ache and slight eye problems. The skin on his cheeks came into a watery blister which was knocked off. Mrs. Landrum said that it looks like it will heal well.

Colby's worst problems were psychological: He had nightmares for 2-3 weeks and wet his bed because he was afraid to get up at night. He didn't want to drive in a car at night. He also routinely slept in his own bed until the incident; it wasn't until February that he could sleep without his mother's company. His grade's had fallen off at school, but are back to normal (A's) now. Betty Cash was mad at the World Weekly News stating that the child "wasn't hurt" because of these problems.

Mrs. Landrum didn't seek medical help because she didn't have the money. She told a Dr. Wilson about the UFO and claims that the doctor didn't want to deal with her... presumably, she feels, because of the UFO aspect. "The



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reason I've been kind of skeptical about the others is because it had taken me four days of trying everywhere - Liberty, Dayton, anywhere - that they would take Betty in... and she was a heart patient, you know?" Afraid that Betty was going to die at her own house, and Betty unable to even tell her who her doctor was, Vicky called Betty's drug store to get Dr. Shenoy's number. Vicky recently attended a health clinic, which told her that her blood pressure is varying. They also arranged for a radiologist in Galveston to attend to her. At the time of this writing, I have not yet heard the results of this visit. One puzzling feature, potentially - Vicky agreed that her health insurance would cover the costs of her examination, yet she continued to use the excuse of money (not wanting to dip into her credit union, etc.) as her excuse for not seeking medical care, even though she is wearing a wig to cover her hair loss.

It was Vicky who got the phone number for Bob Gribble's UFO Reporting Center in Seattle, Washington from a police department. She grumbled about having to spend \$9 talking with them on the phone, but getting no assistance. She also had to call APRO's Bill English back, which cost her another \$7. It wasn't until February - after the tabloid press published her story - that she got in touch with Schuessler.

ADDITIONAL WITNESSES

The tabloid coverage of the event mentioned one seemingly independent witness to the event - Nellie Zitick, 52, at 713-336-5632. She was in the company of her son, John and his wife Toni (they apparently don't want to talk about it, but their number is 713-336-9753). They saw a UFO of similar description a half-hour before Cash/Landrum some 20 miles east of them. Additionally, a news broadcast arranged by MUFON over nine Texas radio stations has netted at least one other witness. Dave Kissinger is dealing with these people at this time.

MEDICAL FOLLOW-UP

Dr. Peter Rank in Madison, Wisconsin has the medical records from Betty Cash's stay at the hospital, and has spoken with Dr. Shenoy to ask additional questions. He is certain that all of the damage that took place - diarrhea notwithstanding - was superficial, that no systemic injury occurred. He was intrigued about the prospect of microwaves, but had little acquaintance with the literature. At the time of this writing, I am about to meet with an expert in non-ionizing radiation (including microwaves) at the Georgia Institute of Technology. I have told Dr. Rank about him in the hope that he would phone him and describe the symptoms over the phone to see whether the Georgia Tech experts would be interested in pursuing the matter. Betty Cash is only a three-hour drive from Atlanta, after all. Dr. Rank preferred that I secure for him some contemporary medical literature on microwave pathology first before dealing with them, however. I hope that this delay does not hold up matters unnecessarily.

NOTES ON THE ATTEMPT TO VERIFY THE WITNESSES' CLAIMS OF MULTIPLE HELICOPTERS IN THE AREA AT THE TIME OF THE SIGHTING:

On April 2 and 3, several inquiries were made to civilian and military organizations regarding the alleged presence of one to two dozen single and tandem rotor helicopters in the area of the sighting:

HOUSTON AIR ROUTE TRAFFIC CONTROL CENTER - (Intercontinental Airport)
Keith Rogers, military liaison and security officer: (██████████) 5 -

"There wasn't anything of any significance back then. I'm sure I would have been aware of it because I'm also pretty heavily into the helicopter operations in this area." Rogers noted that the holiday season "kind of rules out the military because every year they shut down their operations over the holidays."

When asked if a special event would have prompted such an exercise, he said, "anything special I would have been aware of, too, because I'm also the military coordinator here, too... I was here at the time, on duty, so I can't think of any way it could have slipped by..."

When asked about a base likely to use the Dayton area for helicopter flights, Rogers suggested the Army airfield at Ft. Polk. "If they were VFR, we would have had no knowledge of it at the Center. We only deal with IFR-type operations, or operations that would affect airspace, and there was nothing here in that time-frame." Commuter helicopters usually fly off-shore and not in large numbers.

HOUSTON - WILLIAM HOBBY AIRPORT: (██████████) -

The watch supervisor on duty noted that the Dayton-Huffman area is outside of that airport's jurisdiction. He was not aware of any large operation of helicopters in Houston at that time.

ELLINGTON AIR FORCE BASE, HOUSTON: (██████████) - ext. 2332
Army Guard unit, Mr. Nidever - (unit commander not available)

"I checked around with a couple of the pilots here, and they don't remember flying anything about New Year's Eve... we had a joint exercise with the Marines (in January) but we don't fly that close to Christmas." Their routine troop insertion exercises are flown on weekends, not on Mondays, with the Marines. "Usually, at that time of year, half of the people are gone on leave, so it would not be us. I haven't heard anything about this."

Does the base have double rotor helicopters? "Right. We've got CH-47's and we've got UH-1's. We have OH-58's. The Marines have got 'Jolly Greens'."

Would the Army Guard unit fly around the Huffman/Dayton area? "Oh, no, no, we never fly up around there. All of ours is done to the northwest of Houston which is up around Addicks Reservation. We don't fly up around Dayton hardly at all. Addicks is within the city limits." Nor would they fly through the area on their way to Addicks. "I don't think we could even get up there with the 47's and do a troop insertion and come back for fuel. We'd be out of fuel." "I feel certain that we weren't up there at nighttime because that

would be on a Monday, and the only overnights we have are on Friday or Saturday nights." (I'm puzzled about the fuel capacity comment - A.H.)

Nidever referred me to the Naval Air Station in New Orleans as a possible alternative. An Army Reserve Unit in New Orleans has UH-1's, but no tandem rotors. "We're the only tandem rotor aircraft in this area (emphasis added - A.H.)"

An interesting note: "We had a UFO sighting down here earlier, about two years ago. We were called out on this by the sheriff's department of Montgomery County. They had spotted one about two or three times. They had a helicopter out there, we were supposed to go out when they saw it and go chase it down because Mr. Culverson (with the Army Guard) was involved in that."

FT. POLK ARMY AIR FIELD - LEESVILLE, LOUISIANA
(318) 537-2722: Sgt. Marsh

"No, sir, everybody was gone. I handle all the leaves and I was swamped. We had just about 50% of the people gone or off at that time, sir."

MARINE AIR CRAFT GROUP 46 - NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA
(504) 393-3130

"We weren't there then. We had an aircraft accident in the last part of November and didn't fly any in December."

FT. HOOD ARMY AIR FIELD - KILLEEN, TEXAS
(817) 685-7241

"We had absolutely nothing flying during those days because we were shut down during the holidays." Would it be within Ft. Hood's capability to bring helicopter's into the Dayton area? "I don't think it would."

WORLD WEEKLY NEWS - Dick Donovan - LANTANA, FLORIDA
(800) 327-9490

Reporter Donovan who covered the story confirmed that he could not locate any bases in central Texas that would take credit for the helicopters. He did relate a claim made by an individual whose identity he could not divulge that the "UFO" was actually in contact with the local military! The crew indicated that it was experiencing difficulty with the craft and required air assistance. Donovan could not elaborate if this meant that the UFO was actually a man-made craft of some sort. But then, why would two dozen choppers be required for an escort?

CLOSING COMMENTS: All of the individuals with whom I spoke seemed quite sincere in their efforts to assist me. I did not feel that any of them were handing me a preplanned denial in a brusque manner. Donovan made the same remark. The ARTCC military liaison spent some time on the phone with me, for example. The Ellington AFB spokesman put me on hold to go out and ask pilots and flight engineers if they were up at that time without his knowing it. He also told me about that earlier "UFO chase" quite freely. Sgt. Marsh at Ft. Polk hollered to the people around him, asking if a large exercise could have occurred.

John Schuessler has done some additional work in this direction. One of his seemingly independent witnesses of the UFO itself (some 30 minutes earlier than Cash/Landrum) claimed to have heard helicopters. None of the additional witnesses claimed to have seen them.

Betty Cash was shown diagrams of different types of helicopters by Schuessler. She picked out a large Air Force carrier... the type one would expect from Ellington AFB.

In closing, the claim made by all three witnesses in the Cash/Landrum group implicitly incorporates a large number of helicopters. This claim cannot be "objectified" independently. Yet physiological symptoms such as "75% hair loss" certainly indicate an "objective" experience.

For additional comments on a possible helicopter scenario, see the report describing the suggested "ECM mission" hypothesis.